

3.1.3 Methods of joining and use of components

Seams

Content	Potential links to maths and science
Different seam types and their selection and use on different products taking into account the fabric type, effect to be achieved, efficiency of manufacture and after care of product. Students should have knowledge of the specific techniques required when working with different fabric types, eg knitted, checked, stretch, directional, sheer and patterned fabrics.	

Threads

Content	Potential links to maths and science
Including sewing threads, embroidery threads, and special effect threads: • sewing threads: eg polyester and cotton machine thread, buttonhole thread • embroidery threads: eg stranded embroidery, madeira/viscose machine embroidery • special effect threads: eg metallic, glow-in-the-dark, multicoloured.	

Fusible fleece

Content	Potential links to maths and science
The use of heat-sensitive fleece such as Bondaweb ® when joining layers of fabric, eg in applique work.	

The use of fastenings

Content	Potential links to maths and science
The use of fastenings including buttons and buttonholes and loops, zips, poppers, clips, buckles, clasps, Velcro, D-rings, hooks and eyes, fabric and ribbon ties. Selection and application of fastenings for a range of fashion, clothing and textile products taking account of the intended use, fabric type, the effect to be achieved, efficiency of manufacture and after care of product. Students should have an awareness of the different types of fastening within each category, eg open-ended and invisible zips, flat and domed buttons.	

Trims

Content	Potential links to maths and science
• Braids. • Ribbons. • Piping. • Edging. • Bindings. • Fringing. • Lace. • Beads. • Diamantés.	

Components and their appropriateness for a range of products

Content	Potential links to maths and science
Selection of the most appropriate component for a product taking into consideration the style, effect, fabric used, manufacturing considerations, safety in relation to user, availability and cost implications.	

Interfacings, underlinings, linings, interlinings

Content	Potential links to maths and science
Types and applications in relation to fabric weight and construction, and end use of product. Students should have knowledge of the different fabrics used and the reasons for choice in relation to specific products.	